

SAM.gov Registration

Worksheet Pack

Companion to the book 'The SAM.gov Registration Handbook: Entity validation, UEI, CAGE, and the mistakes that cost weeks'.

This is a private study aid. It is not a government form, it is not an official document, and filling it in does not register anything.

You register only at sam.gov, and it is free: registration, renewal, your UEI and your CAGE code. Nobody needs to charge you for any of it, and the government will never email or call you to sell registration help.

These are the fill-in tools from the book, on paper, where you can actually use them. Print this pack and keep it with your formation documents.

Work through them in order. Each one corresponds to a chapter, and the chapter explains why the worksheet asks what it asks. Most of the expensive mistakes in this process are ones a checklist cannot warn you about; the chapters can.

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What is in here

0. The whole process on one page, and which reader you are
1. Pre-flight list - what to have open before you sit down
2. The canonical string - both source rows, and which system checks which
3. Document checklist - what each document proves, and what it does not
4. Timeline tracker - dates, so you can see which wait you are in
5. Renewal calendar and checklist - set it the day you go Active
6. Is this letter from the government? - four questions, in order
7. Your state, your entity type - the half of this that is not federal
8. Every field, with a typical answer - the whole form, section by section
9. Your SBA profile - the page contracting officers actually search

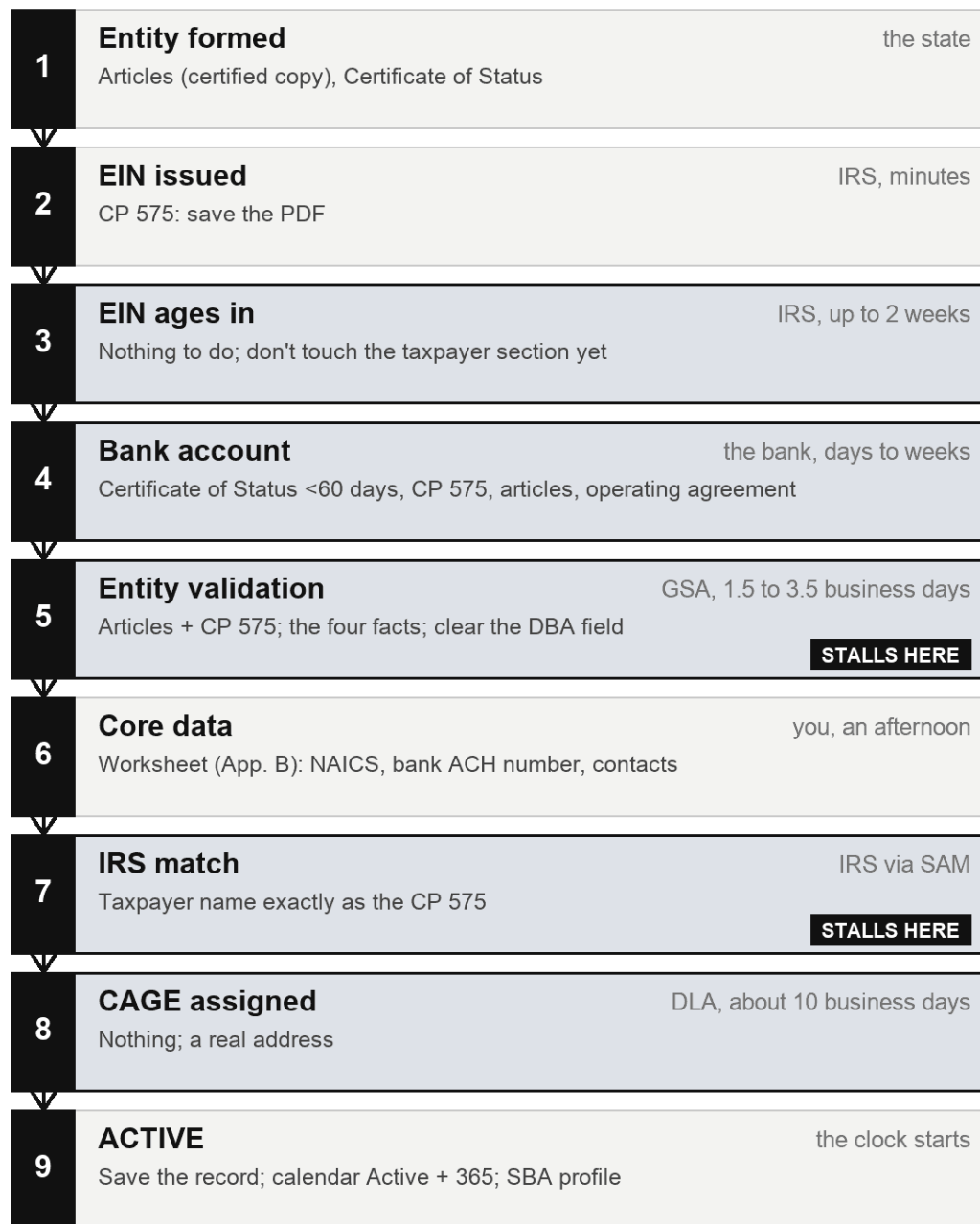
Rules change. Check the date on the book's copyright page, and the book's links page, before relying on anything here.

0. The whole process on one page

Nine links, four waits, what each step consumes, and where it stalls. The book is this page, explained. Pin it up.

THE WHOLE PROCESS ON ONE PAGE

Nine links, four waits on other people's clocks, what each step consumes, and where it stalls.



Links 3, 4, 5 and 8 don't need each other: run them at the same time.
Registration, UEI and CAGE are free.

Which reader are you?

Eight kinds of people pick up this book, and they don't all start at Chapter 1.

You have a solicitation, a grant notice, or a prime asking for your UEI, and a deadline.

Chapter 3 for the order of operations, then Chapter 5. If the deadline is under three weeks, read Chapter 8 tonight: the EIN wait is the one you can't compress.

You're pursuing an SBA certification (veteran-owned, woman-owned, HUBZone, 8(a)).

Chapter 10's last section first, so you know what the SAM boxes do and don't do; then Chapter 13, because the size rule is checked at certification too.

You're applying for an SBIR or STTR award.

Chapters 3 and 5, then Appendix I for the three registrations that follow this one.

You're a non-profit applying for a federal grant.

Appendix I's non-profit section, then Chapter 1 for the registration purpose, then Chapter 3.

You got a letter saying your registration is expiring and there's a fee.

Worksheet 6 on this pack, then Appendix G and Chapter 12. The short answer is that it isn't from the government.

You're a bookkeeper, accountant, or office manager doing this for a client.

Chapter 3's section on doing it for someone else, then worksheet 8 here, which is the whole form with a typical answer beside each field.

A formation service set up your company and stopped at the EIN.

Chapter 3, which starts where they left off, then Chapter 4 before you type anything.

Your company was formed outside the United States.

Appendix L, which is the whole path for a foreign entity: your own country's registry as evidence, the NCAGE-first rule if you'll seek Defense work, and how you get paid.

Everyone else: start at Chapter 1 and read in order. It's a chain.

Four kinds of registrant, what validation asks each

	Established LLC / corp.	New LLC / corp.	Sole proprietor	Non-profit
Validation asks for	Often only the address; sometimes nothing	All four facts	Name and address, no state filing to lean on	All four facts, plus the IRS determination letter
Best evidence	IRS letter + latest annual report	Certified articles + IRS letter	License or bank statement + utility bill	Certified articles, IRS letter, determination letter
The wait you'll notice	Validation review	EIN aging, overlapped with the bank	Proving the address	Grants.gov and the agency system after SAM
Registration purpose	All Awards	All Awards	All Awards	Financial Assistance Awards Only, unless you'll ever contract
Read first	Chapters 5 and 12	Chapters 3, 5 and 8	Chapter 5's sole-proprietor section, then Chapter 10	Appendix I's non-profit section, then Chapter 10

1. Pre-flight list

The registration is one sitting if everything is open before you start. Tick each item. See Chapters 3 and 6.

Signed in and ready

- ☐ Login.gov account exists, second factor set up, and you are signed in
- ☐ A monitored email address is the one on the Login.gov account
- ☐ Worksheet 2 (the canonical string) filled in and open beside you

Files open, named so a stranger can tell what they are

- ☐ Certified copy of the articles of organization / incorporation (PDF)
- ☐ IRS EIN letter, CP 575 or 147C (PDF)
- ☐ Most recent state annual report, if the entity has filed one (PDF)
- ☐ Fictitious-name (DBA) registration, ONLY if you use a DBA

Numbers on paper

- ☐ EIN, as printed on the IRS letter
- ☐ The EIN's issue date, and the date two weeks after it
- ☐ Bank ACH routing number (not wire) and account number, from the bank in writing
- ☐ Primary NAICS code and its size standard; secondary codes
- ☐ Formation date (the EFFECTIVE date, if the filing shows two)

Decisions made

- ☐ Registration purpose: All Awards (unless you will never bid on a contract)
- ☐ Public search: stay in, or opt out (Chapter 10 - HUBZone and 8(a) require in)
- ☐ Who holds the Electronic Business point of contact (normally you)

If the EIN is less than two weeks old, submit entity validation now and stop before the taxpayer section. The IRS match will fail on a new EIN.

2. The canonical string

Two official records hold your name and address, and they may not match. Copy each EXACTLY as printed. From now on, paste from this page and never retype. See Chapter 4.

Row 1 - as the IRS letter prints it (use for SAM.gov)

Legal business name

Street

Unit / Suite

City, State, ZIP+4

Keep the IRS's abbreviations and capitalization even if they look wrong to you. SAM's taxpayer check compares against this record.

Row 2 - as the state record shows it (use for the bank)

Legal business name

Street

Unit / Suite

City, State, ZIP

If the two rows differ by more than formatting (a different street, an old address), stop and fix the wrong record before continuing.

Dates and identifiers

Formation date (effective)

State of incorporation

Fiscal year end

EIN

Taxpayer name (per CP 575)

Issued by the process - fill in as they arrive

Validation reference no.

UEI

CAGE code

Active date

Expiration (Active + 365)

Which system checks which row

- ☐ SAM entity validation - Row 1 (then your uploaded documents)
- ☐ SAM taxpayer check - Row 1, exactly
- ☐ Bank account title - Row 2; ask them to type it as Row 1 anyway
- ☐ SAM EFT section - the bank's account title, character for character
- ☐ Any later SBA certification - both, against each other

3. Document checklist

Gather these once, as PDFs, named clearly. The right-hand note says what the document is for, and the important ones say what it is NOT for. See Chapter 5 and Appendix A.

- ☐ Certified copy of the articles - Entity validation: proves all four facts. Bank.
- ☐ IRS EIN letter (CP 575 / 147C) - Entity validation: name + address. Taxpayer name. Bank.
- ☐ Most recent state annual report - Entity validation: name, address, state.
- ☐ Certificate of Status / Good Standing (< 60 days) - Bank. Validation: name and date ONLY - it prints no address.
- ☐ Business bank statement (< 5 years) - Entity validation: name + address, if the state documents fall short.
- ☐ Utility bill in the business name (< 5 years) - Entity validation: address. Water, gas or electric only.
- ☐ Fictitious-name (DBA) registration - Only if the DBA field is populated. Otherwise leave that field EMPTY.
- ☐ Executed operating agreement / bylaws - Bank. Later certifications. Not on GSA's validation list.
- ☐ Bank's ACH routing + account number, in writing - SAM Financial Information section.
- ☐ Photo identification - Bank.
- ☐ Beneficial-ownership information - Bank completes it with you. Nothing in SAM asks for it.

GSA's rule: at least one upload must show the full legal name AND the current physical address together. Upload two documents even when one would do; a rejection costs days and a second upload costs seconds.

4. Timeline tracker

Fill in dates as you go. The point is to see which wait you are in, and whose clock it runs on. See Chapter 3 and Appendix C.

Entity filed / effective date	_____	<i>The state</i>
Certified copy of articles ordered	_____	<i>Order it WITH the filing</i>
EIN issued	_____	<i>Save the CP 575 PDF now</i>
EIN + 14 days	_____	<i>IRS: 'wait up to 2 weeks' for TIN matching</i>
Bank: application submitted	_____	
Bank: documents uploaded	_____	<i>Check the dashboard to-do list</i>
Bank: interview / call completed	_____	
Bank: account open, ACH routing in hand	_____	
SAM: entity validation submitted	_____	<i>Do NOT wait for the EIN to age</i>
SAM: validation reference number	_____	<i>Write it here:</i>
Worry date (submission + 4 business days)	_____	<i>Then open a service desk case</i>
SAM: validation cleared, UEI assigned	_____	<i>GSA: 1.5-3.5 business days</i>
SAM: taxpayer section passed the IRS match	_____	
SAM: all sections complete, submitted	_____	
SAM: ACTIVE, CAGE assigned	_____	<i>SAM.gov: 'up to 10 business days'</i>
Expiration date written in the calendar	_____	<i>Active + 365 days</i>

Business days, not calendar days. A Friday-night submission starts its clock on Monday. If the worry date passes with no change, open ONE case with the Federal Service Desk, quoting the reference number. Never start a second registration to get around a stall.

5. Renewal calendar

The registration expires 365 days after it goes Active, and the lapse is silent. Set these the day you go Active, one set per entity. See Chapter 12.

Entity

Legal business name

UEI

The dates

Active date

Expiration (Active + 365)

Weekend? The Friday before

Reminder 1 (60 days out)

Reminder 2 (30 days out)

Reminder 1: 'Start SAM renewal'. Reminder 2: 'SAM renewal NOT DONE'. Renewal is free, re-runs validation, and can stall the way the original did. If reminder 2 fires and it is not done, that is the day to open a service desk case.

Changes that must be updated when they happen, not at renewal

- ☐ New physical address
- ☐ Change of legal name
- ☐ Change of ownership or control
- ☐ New bank account (keep the old one open until the first payment lands)

What the genuine reminder looks like

SAM.gov sends several email reminders before expiration, from a .gov address, to the email on your Login.gov account. They tell you to sign in at sam.gov. They never carry a fee, a phone number to call, or a deadline shorter than the expiration date you wrote above.

5b. Renewal checklist

Before you start the renewal, not during it: pull a fresh Certificate of Status if a later certification will want one; check the state annual report is filed, because a lapsed state entity can't be validated; and compare this year's receipts to the size standard on worksheet 2, because the size box is the one you're certifying again. See Chapter 12.

- ☐ Certificate of Status current, or re-ordered
- ☐ State annual report filed
- ☐ This year's receipts and employees checked against the size standard
- ☐ Bank account still open; routing and account number unchanged
- ☐ Every point of contact still with the company (a departed helper removed)

What the renewal re-checks, section by section

Section	What you'll be asked	What it re-validates	The common failure
Entity information	Confirm name, address, start date	Entity validation, if the name or address changed; sometimes even if not	An address that drifted: a move, a new suite number, an agent's address entered by mistake
Taxpayer	Confirm the taxpayer name and EIN	The IRS match	A name changed with the state but not with the IRS
Financial information	Confirm the bank details	Treasury's EFT validation	An account closed or moved during the year
Business types and size	Re-affirm size with this year's receipts and employees	Your size representation, freshly certified	Growth past the size standard with the box left ticked
Reps and certs	Re-affirm every box	Each representation, as of today	A fact that changed: a new owner, a conviction, a tax delinquency
Points of contact	Confirm each	Nothing, but a departed consultant is still listed here	The Electronic Business point of contact who left
Submit	The same final checks as the original	IRS match, then CAGE, then Active	Submitting in the last week and hitting a validation ticket

6. Is this letter from the government?

Keep this wherever the business mail lands. Four questions, in order. See Chapter 12 and Appendix G.

1. Does it ask for money?

The government charges nothing for registration, renewal, a UEI, a CAGE code, or any certificate. Any dollar amount means it is not from the government. Stop here.

2. Where does it come from?

Government mail about SAM comes from a .gov address. Read any web address from the right-hand end: the last part before the first single slash is who you are talking to. 'sam.gov' is the government. 'sam-gov-renewals.com' and 'sam.gov.verify.example.com' are not.

3. What does it want you to do?

Genuine reminders tell you to sign in at sam.gov. They do not ask you to call a number, reply with information, click to 'activate', or scan a code.

4. Does knowing your UEI, CAGE or registration date prove anything?

No. Those are on your public record by design. A letter that quotes them has read the registry, not come from it.

GSA's own list: SAM.gov will never

- ☐ Ask for personal information anywhere except within SAM.gov itself
- ☐ Ask for money or threaten legal action or liability
- ☐ Ask you to call or text anybody
- ☐ Send a link that doesn't end in .gov
- ☐ Advertise on social media

What to do with the rest

Nothing. Don't call, reply, or click. To report it: reportfraud.ftc.gov, ic3.gov, or the GSA Inspector General hotline at gsaig.gov. Then renew your own registration, yourself, at sam.gov, in the window on worksheet 5.

Log the ones you receive

Date / sender / the tell

Date / sender / the tell

Date / sender / the tell

Date / sender / the tell

7. Your state, your entity type

The federal half of this process - Login.gov, SAM.gov, the IRS check, the CAGE code - is the same everywhere. The state half is not. Fill this page in once, from your own state's filing office. See Appendix H.

Find your state's office by searching your state's name plus 'division of corporations' or 'Secretary of State business filing'. Confirm the address ends in .gov before entering anything.

Your filing office

Office name _____

Entity search URL (.gov) _____

Good-standing doc name _____

The numbers

Formation fee _____

Certified copy of articles _____

Certificate of status _____

Annual or biennial report fee _____

Late penalty _____

The dates

Separate effective date? _____

Report deadline _____

Certificate valid until _____

Banks commonly want the certificate file-stamped within 60 days. A slow account application can outlive one; re-order if it does.

Entity type - what changes in SAM

- ☐ LLC / corporation: state of incorporation = the forming state; start year from the filing
- ☐ Sole proprietor: no state; start year = when you began; get an EIN anyway; evidence is a license, bank statement or utility bill
- ☐ Non-profit: expect to be asked for the IRS determination letter; choose All Awards if you will ever contract
- ☐ Foreign entity: NCAGE first ONLY if seeking Department of Defense awards

Registered agent

Who is your agent _____

- ☐ The agent's address is NOT the physical address SAM wants

8. Every field, with a typical answer

The whole form in one place, with a plausible answer for the commonest case: a domestic, single-owner LLC, newly formed, no revenue, no employees but the owner, registering for All Awards. Where your answer differs, the right-hand column says where to work it out. Paste the name and address rows from worksheet 2; never retype them. See Appendix K.

Entity validation (Chapter 6)

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Registration purpose	All Awards	Chapter 1
Entity type	Business or Organization	Chapter 6
Legal business name	Row 1 of worksheet 2, IRS wording	Worksheet 2
Doing Business As	Blank. Clear it if SAM filled it in	Chapter 6
Physical address	Row 1 of worksheet 2, line by line	Worksheet 2
Mailing address	Same as physical	Chapter 6
Start date	The effective date on the state filing	Chapter 4
Fiscal year end	December 31	Chapter 4
State of incorporation	The forming state	Chapter 4
Existing CAGE code?	No	Chapter 6
Documents uploaded	Certified articles; IRS CP 575	Chapter 5, worksheet 3

Taxpayer information (Chapter 8)

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Taxpayer name	Exactly as printed on the CP 575, capitals and all	Chapter 8
TIN type	EIN	Chapter 8
EIN	From the CP 575	Worksheet 2
IRS consent	Ticked	Chapter 8
Fiscal year end	December 31	Chapter 4
Entity structure	Limited Liability Company	Chapter 8
Organization type	For-profit organization	Chapter 8
State and country of incorporation	The forming state; United States	Chapter 4

General information (Chapter 10)

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Company website, division	Blank unless the site exists and is yours	Chapter 10
Congressional district	Derived by SAM from ZIP+4	Chapter 6
Business start date	The same effective date	Chapter 4

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Number of employees	1	Chapter 4
Annual receipts	0	Chapter 10
Immediate owner / highest-level owner	None	Chapter 10
Predecessor entity	None	Chapter 10

Financial information (Chapter 9)

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Financial institution	As the bank writes its name	Chapter 9
ABA routing number	The ACH routing number, nine digits, from the bank in writing	Chapter 9
Account number	From the bank's paperwork	Chapter 9
Account type	Checking	Chapter 9
Remittance name and address	Legal name; Row 1 address	Worksheet 2
Accounts receivable POC	You	Chapter 10

Executive compensation and proceedings (Chapter 10)

Question	Typical answer	Why
80% or more and \$25 million or more of revenue from federal awards last year?	No	New company
Officers' compensation already public through SEC or IRS filings?	No	Private company
Active federal awards over \$10 million with proceedings to report?	No	New company

Business types and size (Chapters 10 and 13)

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Organization type	For-profit	Chapter 10
Small business	Yes, with affiliates counted	Chapter 13
Manufacturer?	No, for a services company	Chapter 10
Country of ownership	United States	Chapter 10
Foreign-government control?	No	Chapter 10

Goods and services (Chapter 10)

Field	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Primary NAICS	The code whose size standard you'll stay under longest and whose description a contracting officer would recognize as your work	Chapter 10
Secondary NAICS	The adjacent codes you'd actually bid under	Chapter 10
Product and Service Codes	Optional; two or three if you know what you'll bid on	Chapter 10
Size metrics	0 receipts, 1 employee	Chapter 10
EDI information	Skip	
Disaster response registry	Optional	

Representations and certifications (Chapter 10)

Representation	Typical answer	Why
Small business concern	Yes	You're certifying it; Chapter 13
Veteran-owned, service-disabled veteran-owned	The facts; a statement, not a certification	Chapter 10
Woman-owned, HUBZone, small disadvantaged	The facts; statements, not certifications	Chapter 10
Delinquent federal debt	No	FAR 52.209-5
Unpaid federal tax liability	No	FAR 52.209-5
Convictions, civil judgments, indictments (three years)	No	FAR 52.209-5
Debarred, suspended, proposed for debarment	No	FAR 52.209-5; Chapter 7
Lobbying activities	No	Chapter 10
Manufacturer / place of manufacture	No; not applicable for services	Chapter 10
Country of origin	United States	Chapter 10
Owned or controlled by a foreign government	No	Chapter 10

Points of contact (Chapter 10)

Role	Typical answer	Note
Entity Administrator	You	Add a second one while you can (Chapter 3)
Electronic Business POC	You	The gate to Grants.gov, PIEE and the rest (Appendix I)
Government Business	You	Monitored email
Past Performance	You	

Role	Typical answer	Note
Accounts Receivable	You	

After submission

Decision	Typical answer	Where it comes from
Public search	Stay in, unless you have a specific reason and no HUBZone or 8(a) plans	Chapter 10
SBA profile (Small Business Search)	Complete it the same day: keywords, capability narrative, past performance	Chapter 11; worksheet 9
Calendar	Expiration = Active + 365; reminders at 60 and 30 days	Chapter 12; worksheet 5

9. Your SBA profile

When SAM hands you to SBA's supplemental pages, what you enter becomes the profile that contracting officers and small business specialists actually search. Draft it here first; the fields are short. Write it for the search, not for a brochure: a buyer types a phrase and reads the first line of each result. See Chapter 11.

This hand-off is the part of the process most likely to have changed since the book was printed. Check the links page for the current address before you go looking for a screen.

Capability narrative (three or four plain sentences: what you do, for whom, what makes you the right call)

Keywords (the words a buyer would type: services, tools, industries, certifications held)

NAICS codes (the same set as SAM, primary first)

Past performance references (any relevant work, federal or not, with a contact who'll answer)

Client / contact / what you did

Client / contact / what you did

Client / contact / what you did

Bonding levels (construction only)

Aggregate / per project

Capability statement

- ☐ A one-page PDF exists and is attached to the profile
- ☐ Profile updated when NAICS codes or certifications change (a stale profile is worse than an empty one)